DATA ITEM DESCRIPTION

Title: Concept of Operations (CONOPS)

Number: DI-ADMN-82528
AMSC Number: 10647
DTIC Applicable: N/A
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Project Number: ADMN-2026-003

Use/relationship: A CONOPS is a document that describes a proposed system concept and how that concept would be operated in an intended environment. The user community develops the CONOPS to communicate the vision for the operational system to the acquisition and developer community. A CONOPS can also be written by the buyer, developer, or acquirer to communicate their understanding of the user needs and how a system will fulfill them.

Requirements:

The goals of a CONOPS are as follows:

- To provide a clear vision of the intended use and the resulting benefits of the system.
- To provide a forum to stimulate information exchange at the operational level on major technical and programmatic issues among the system's users, operators, and developers to facilitate a clear understanding of the system context and the users' view of the completed system.
- To provide a document which can be understood and utilized by all members of the CONOPS audience.
- To highlight differences between current operations and desired future operations.
- To provide the basis for system validation.

To meet these goals, the CONOPS should therefore:

- Describe the desired system features and characteristics from an operational perspective.
- Provide a description of the system’s, users’, and operators’ environment.
- Describe how the system will be used.
- Facilitate understanding of the overall system goals among users (including recipients of the products of the system where applicable), buyers, implementers, architects, testers, and managers.
- Form an overall basis for long-range operations planning and provide guidance for development of subsequent system definition documents such as the system specification and the interface specification.

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- Describe the user organization and mission from an integrated user/system point of view.

This DoW/DISA template is tailorable to fit the needs of the program or project. The CONOPS contents are organized to tell a story, describing the current system, if any, operational processes in the mission area, enumerating the user and mission needs, providing an overview of the envisioned system capabilities and architecture, and tying it all together by detailing scenarios of how the system will be used in accomplishing the various operational processes. It provides unique information regarding the operational use of the system, the processes followed, and typical scenarios of usage

1. **Reference documents.** ANSI/AIAA G-043B-2018, Guide to the Preparation of Operational Concept Documents; DoW/DISA Template. https://webstore.ansi.org/sdo/aiaa

2. **Format.** The plan shall be in Government format. LCSP will be delivered in the most recent Department of War (DoW) / Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA) template.

3. **Content.**

3.1 DOCUMENT SCOPE

This Concept of Operations (CONOPS) provides the framework for [Tool/System Name] operations across all [Operating Agency] operated [Network Name]. As a key component of the defense-in-depth /zero trust strategy for the [Network Name], the [Tool/System Name] supports [Command/Organization Name] requirements for [purpose]. It delivers [.....]. The modifications detailed in this CONOPS are designed to align the functionality of [Tool/System Name] with [Governing Instruction/Policy] and to revise operations to meet [Requirements].

3.1.1 Document Overview

This document details the operational concepts for the implementation and lifecycle support of the [System Name]'s design. It describes the system's capabilities, operational intent, and provides information on its lifecycle support and network operations. This CONOPS will be maintained and revised as the system matures. The intended audience for this document includes all [System Name] stakeholders.

The intended audience for this document is all [System Name] system stakeholders, including but not limited to:

3.2 BACKGROUND INFORMATION

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The purpose of this section is to provide the operational context and justification for the new or existing capability. It establishes the mission requirement by contrasting the significant risks and limitations of the previous manual process with the improvements in efficiency, speed, and reliability offered by the new system. This effectively answers "why" the new concept of operations is necessary.

3.2.1 System Identification

This CONOPS applies to the deployed [system] on the NIPRNet. Provides the Enterprise Mission Assurance Support Service (eMASS) and Defense Information Technology Portfolio(DITPR) identification numbers for the current system.

3.2.2 Information System Categorization

The system has been categorized at the following severity levels: Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability.

3.2.3 Organizational Design

The following section provides information on the organizational structure of the [program] under the oversight of [Organization].

3.2.3.1 Information System Owner

Name:
Title:
Address:
Email address:
Phone number:

3.2.3.2 Authorizing Official (AO)

Name:
Title:
Address:
Email address:
Phone number:

3.2.3.3 Other Designated Contacts

Name:
Title:
Address:
Email address:
Phone number:

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3.2.4 Project Management

The purpose of this section is to define the governance and management of the operational schedule, cost, and performance. It specifies the authoritative document that establishes the timeline, the process for its regular maintenance, and the reporting structure for ensuring leadership has situational awareness of progress and key milestones and deliverables. You can discuss management documents (e.g., Task Order Management Plan).

3.3 SERVICE STRATEGY

3.3.1 Demand Management

3.3.2 Financial Management

3.4 SERVICE DESIGN

3.4.1 System Scope

3.4.2 Policies

3.4.3 Constraints

3.4.4 Users and Operators

3.4.5 Service Delivery Roles & Responsibilities

End of DI-ADMN-82528

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